GEOTEC Journal Club

Charter

GEOTEC research group

2026-11-05

The GEOTEC Journal Club is a **monthly, 60–70 minute session** where members discuss **one paper** to foster critical reading, debate and presentation: judging its methods, assumptions, results and contribution, as well as its academic writing style.

Purpose

What it is

A space to debate a paper's methods, assumptions, validity and writing, and to practise arguing about them.

What it is not

A way to keep up to date with a specific field or subfield, although every paper has a clear link to GIScience. Members work on different topics, so selected papers will not always connect to each member's research.

Why it matters

It develops transferable competences in the ResearchComp framework, mainly *critical thinking*, *analytical thinking* and *evaluating research*.

Who takes part

Open to all GEOTEC members: PhD students, faculty and other research profiles. Everyone takes a turn as facilitator.

Format

Table 1: Session format

Item	Rule
Frequency	Monthly
Duration	60–70 minutes
Papers per session	One
Paper length	Maximum 15 pages
Announcement	At least one week before the session
Facilitator	One person per session, on a rotation published at the start of each semester

Each session follows the same structure:

Table 2: Session structure

Block	Led by	Time
Context	Facilitator	5 min
Summary	Facilitator	10 min
Critical discussion	Everyone	30–40 min
Takeaways	Everyone	5–10 min

Roles

Facilitator

Selects the paper using the shared selection criteria, announces it one week ahead, gives the context and summary, and guides the discussion.

Attendees

Read the paper before the session and bring one question or critique.

Ground rules

! Important

1. Everyone reads the paper, not only the facilitator.
2. Critique the paper, not the people.
3. "I didn't understand X" is a welcome contribution.
4. The shared guiding questions frame every discussion.

Record and review

- Each session is archived on the group's Quarto website: paper, facilitator, date, slides and key takeaways (see the minutes template).
- At the end of each semester (6 sessions), members hold a short retrospective and may propose changes to this charter.